Unit - 5

Educational Development in India



Learning Objectives

- Know the ancient system of education in India
- Understand the development of education in medieval and modern India
- Analyse the educational development during the British Rule
- Discuss the importance of National Education Policy
- Understand the educational development in Tamil Nadu

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Knowledge is the third eye of man.

Introduction

Education is a continuous process of aqring and sharing of knowledge, skills and values. Education is recognised as the foundation of a progressive society. It plays a vital role in shaping responsible people. The world we live is constantly changing and developing. So, to meet the challenges and overcome the obstacles we need to be well educated and to know the role of the education in the human development process. Let us learn the development of education in India through the ages.

Education in Ancient India

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The historical sources provide the information that from very early times, the tradition of teaching and learning had been in vogue in India. The concept of Education might have originated from the Vedas. The literal meaning the Sanskrit word 'Veda' is knowledge and the word derived from the word Vid, which means 'to know'. Our ancient education system evolved over many centuries and focused on the holistic development of the individual by taking care of both the innate and latents capacities. It emphasised on values such as humility, truthfulness, discipline, self-reliance and respect for all creations.

Sources of Learning

You must have heard the names of Panini, Aryabhata, Katyayana and Patanjali. Their writings and the medical treatises of Charaka and Sushruta were also some of the sources of learning. Various disciplines such as history, logic, interpretation, architecture, polity, agriculture, trade, commerce, animal husbandry and archery were taught. Physical education too was an important curricular area and pupils participated in games and recreational activities. The Gurus and their students worked conscientiously together to become proficient in all aspects of learning.

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